■ CRA Rules & Complete Guide — All 5 Accounts

TFSA · RRSP + Spousal · RESP · FHSA · Margin · All 13 Provinces

P12 Ultimate Tracker v1.0 · CA$44.99 · maplesheeet.etsy.com

■ PART 1 — TFSA CRA RULES (2026)

Rule	Key Fact	What It Means
2026 Annual Limit	**$7,000/year**	January 1 each year. Room accumulates from age 18. Check CRA My Account for your exact cumulative room.
Unused Room	**Carries forward indefinitely**	All unused room from every prior year carries forward. Never expires.
Withdrawal Room Restored	**January 1 next year**	Withdraw $5,000 in 2026 — room restored January 1, 2027. Not immediately.
Over-Contribution	**1%/month penalty**	CRA charges monthly on excess. File RC243 to report and pay.
Tax-Free Growth	**100% exempt — never on T1**	All dividends, capital gains, interest inside TFSA are completely tax-free. Never reported on T1.
No Age Limit	**Contribute forever**	Unlike RRSP — no age 71 deadline. Contribute as long as you are a Canadian resident.
US Stocks Warning	**15% IRS withholding**	The Canada-US Tax Treaty does NOT cover TFSA. US dividends in TFSA lose 15% to IRS permanently. Hold US stocks in RRSP instead.

■ PART 2 — RRSP + SPOUSAL RRSP CRA RULES (2026)

Rule	Key Fact	What It Means
2026 RRSP Limit	**$33,810/year**	Lesser of $33,810 or 18% of 2025 earned income. Check Notice of Assessment.
60-Day Grace Period	**March 1, 2027**	Jan 1–Mar 1, 2027 contributions apply to 2026 T1. Applies to both own RRSP and Spousal RRSP.
Spousal Uses Contributor Room	**YOUR room only**	Contributing to Spousal RRSP uses YOUR RRSP room. Annuitant room unaffected.
3-Year Attribution Rule	**Calendar years**	ANY spousal contribution triggers 3-year window. Even $1. Measured in calendar years not 36 months.
Line 208 — Both Accounts	**Contributor claims**	Both own RRSP and Spousal RRSP contributions deducted on YOUR Line 208.
Contribute Past Age 71	**If spouse is younger**	After your own RRSP converts to RRIF at 71, contribute to Spousal RRSP until ANNUITANT turns 71.
RRIF Minimum Exempt	**Min payment exempt**	Only above-minimum RRIF withdrawals trigger attribution. Minimums always taxed to annuitant.
Form T2205	**When attributed**	Annuitant files T2205 when attribution applies.
Over-Contribution Buffer	**$2,000 lifetime**	Beyond $2K buffer: 1%/month. File T1-OVP.
Unused Room	**Carries forward indefinitely**	RRSP unused room never expires. Check CRA My Account annually.

■ PART 3 — RESP + CESG CRA RULES

Rule	Key Fact	What It Means
Annual Contribution	**No annual limit**	But CESG only applies to first $2,500/yr per child. Contributions above $2,500 earn no additional CESG.
CESG — Basic Grant	**$500/yr per child**	20% match on first $2,500 contributed per beneficiary per year. Max $500/yr.
CESG Lifetime Maximum	**$7,200 per child**	Once reached for a beneficiary, no further CESG is issued for that child.
RESP Lifetime Limit	**$50,000 per beneficiary**	Over-contributions face 1%/month CRA penalty.
CESG Eligibility Deadline	**Age 17 (Dec 31)**	Last calendar year eligible = year the beneficiary turns 17. Contribute before Dec 31.
Catch-Up Room	**Max $5,000/yr total**	Missed prior years? Contribute up to $5,000 for $1,000 CESG. CRA limits to one catch-up year at a time.
EAP Taxation	**Taxed to student**	CESG + growth (EAP) taxed to student at their low rate. Principal returned to subscriber tax-free.
RESP Collapse	**CESG must be repaid**	No post-secondary: all CESG repaid to CRA. Contributions back tax-free. Growth taxed + 20% penalty.
Family Plan	**Up to 4 beneficiaries**	One RESP can hold multiple children. CESG room cannot be shared between beneficiaries.
CLB — Canada Learning Bond	**Up to $2,000**	Low-income families: $500 Year 1 + $100/yr up to age 15.

■ PART 4 — FHSA CRA RULES (2026)

Rule	Key Fact	What It Means
Annual Limit	**$8,000/year**	December 31 deadline. NO 60-day grace period. Miss it and the room is lost.
Lifetime Limit	**$40,000**	1%/month CRA penalty on excess. File Schedule 15 with T1 every year from account open date.
Carry-Forward Room	**Max $8,000 forward**	Only 1 year of unused room carries forward. Max in any single year: $16,000 ($8K current + $8K prior).
Room Starts WHEN	**Account open date**	Unlike TFSA — room does NOT accumulate from age 18. Open FHSA ASAP even with $0 balance.
Tax Deduction	**Line 20805**	Contributions are tax-deductible. Deduction can be carried forward to a higher-income year.
Tax-Free Growth	**100% exempt**	All dividends, capital gains, interest inside FHSA — never on T1.
Qualifying Withdrawal	**Tax-free · no repayment**	First home only. Unlike RRSP HBP — FHSA withdrawal is NEVER repaid.
Combine with HBP	**Same home purchase**	FHSA ($40K) + RRSP HBP ($60K) for same home. Couple: $40K+$40K+$60K+$60K = $200K combined.
Account Lifespan	**15 years or age 71**	Must close FHSA by December 31 of 15th year or year you turn 71, whichever is earlier.
If No Home	**Transfer to RRSP**	Roll FHSA to RRSP tax-free — no RRSP room used. Growth taxable at withdrawal in retirement.

■ PART 5 — MARGIN ACCOUNT CRA RULES

Rule	Key Fact	What It Means
ACB Required	**Every buy and sell**	CRA requires Adjusted Cost Base tracking for every non-registered security. This tracker auto-calculates.
Capital Gains	**50% inclusion rate**	50% of capital gains are included in taxable income. Report on Schedule 3.
Capital Losses	**Offset gains**	Losses offset gains in same year, carry back 3 years, or carry forward indefinitely.
Margin Interest	**Line 22100**	Interest on money borrowed to invest in income-producing assets is deductible as investment expense.
Eligible Dividends	**Dividend tax credit**	Canadian eligible dividends receive the federal dividend tax credit — more tax-efficient than interest.
T5 Slip	**From broker**	Broker issues T5 for dividends and interest received. ACB from your own records for capital gains.
Superficial Loss Rule	**30-day window**	Sell at a loss and repurchase within 30 days before or after — capital loss is denied. CRA rule.
US Dividends in Margin	**15% IRS withholding**	15% withheld by IRS. 15% foreign tax credit on T1 (partially recoverable). Better placement = RRSP.

■■ PART 6 — 2026 FEDERAL BRACKETS + OPTIMAL ACCOUNT PLACEMENT

$0 — $57,375	15%	$18K deduction × 15% = $2,700	Claim now if income stable
$57,376 — $114,750	20.5%	$18K deduction × 20.5% = $3,690	Good saving — claim or carry forward
$114,751 — $158,519	26%	$18K deduction × 26% = $4,680	Consider carrying forward to this bracket
$158,520 — $220,000	29%	$18K deduction × 29% = $5,220	Very strong — carry forward if possible
$220,001+	33%	$18K deduction × 33% = $5,940	Maximum value — carry forward to this bracket

■ OPTIMAL ACCOUNT PLACEMENT — WHERE TO HOLD WHAT

US Dividend Stocks (AAPL, KO, etc.)	RRSP	Canada-US Treaty exempts RRSP from 15% IRS withholding. TFSA/FHSA NOT exempt.
Canadian Dividend ETFs (TSE:VDY, TSE:XDIV)	TFSA or FHSA	Eligible div tax credit in Margin too. But tax-free in TFSA/FHSA is better.
Growth ETFs (TSE:XEQT, TSE:VFV)	TFSA → FHSA → RRSP	Tax-free compounding most valuable for long-term growth assets.
Bonds / Fixed Income (TSE:XBB)	RESP or RRSP	Interest income fully taxable in Margin. Tax-deferred in RRSP/RESP is much better.
Canadian Stocks for Margin Account	Margin	Eligible dividend tax credit + Line 22100 interest deduction makes non-reg viable.
Any investment near first home purchase	FHSA	Triple tax advantage for qualifying withdrawal — deductible IN, tax-free growth, tax-free OUT.

■■ ALL 13 PROVINCES — COMBINED FEDERAL + PROVINCIAL TOP RATES

Province	Code	Prov. Rate Range	Top Combined Rate	Notes
Alberta	AB	10% flat	25.00%	Most tax-friendly. Flat provincial rate.
British Columbia	BC	5.06%–20.50%	53.50%	7 brackets. Top rate above $240,716.
Manitoba	MB	10.80%–17.40%	50.40%	3 brackets.
New Brunswick	NB	9.40%–21.30%	53.30%	5 brackets.

Newfoundland	NL	8.70%–21.80%	54.80%	Highest top rate in Atlantic Canada.
Nova Scotia	NS	8.79%–21.50%	54.00%	5 brackets + surtax.
Northwest Territories	NT	5.90%–14.05%	47.05%	4 brackets.
Nunavut	NU	4.00%–11.50%	44.50%	Lowest provincial rates in Canada.
Ontario	ON	5.05%–13.16%	53.53%	5 brackets + Ontario surtax.
Prince Edward Island	PE	9.65%–18.75%	51.37%	4 brackets + surtax.
Quebec	QC	14.00%–25.75%	53.31%	4 brackets. File separate TP-1 return.
Saskatchewan	SK	10.50%–14.50%	47.50%	3 brackets.
Yukon	YT	6.40%–15.00%	48.00%	Follows federal structure closely.

This guide is for educational reference only. Tax laws change annually. Consult a CPA or tax professional before filing your T1 return or making major investment decisions.